Sample copy, built from four real audits

Website conversion audit example

October 2026 · Prepared by Luca

A close read of where visitors slip away before booking, and the handful of changes most likely to bring them back. Every finding below was seen on a real business website, or in Google's answers about a real business, and checked on 2, 10, 14 or 28 October 2026. The four leaks come from four different businesses, put together in one report so that none of them can be recognised. Names, places, brands and prices are left out. The measurements are the ones I took.

4	3	4
leaks found, each one measured on the live page	things already working, worth protecting	changes, in the order I would make them

What is already working

An audit that only lists problems reads like a sales pitch. These are the strengths worth protecting.

An award on the first screen

The homepage shows an award badge dated 2025 at the bottom of its first screen. A visitor who has never heard of the business gets a reason to trust it before scrolling.

The price is published

The business states what one of its services costs, in its online booking menu. Some of the sites I look at publish no figure at all. This one has already decided to show it, which makes Leak 02 a question of where, not whether.

Customers' words, already collected

The site has a reviews page with a slideshow of testimonials. The work of asking customers and gathering what they said is done.

Protect these while you fix the leaks on the following pages.

Leak 01 · Every booking button · Effort: low

Every booking button opens a sign in screen

What I found

The book button in the menu, three more on the homepage and both booking buttons on one of the service pages all lead to the same place: the sign in form of the business's booking system. It asks for a username, email or mobile phone, with a button to create an account under it. The way on to the actual booking page is a small link lower down that reads "Return to Booking Page", set in 14 pixel type under a 40 pixel heading. I collected the booking links from 19 pages of the site and all of them point to that one sign in address. I checked them on 2 October.

Why it matters

A new customer who presses Book wants to see which times are open. They are asked to sign in to an account they do not have. Returning customers may well sign in, and I did not go past that screen, so I cannot say what they see next. The first time visitor is the one this stops.

What fixing it changes

The sign in screen itself carries a link back to the booking page, so the page a new customer needs is already there. Nothing has to be built.

The fix

Point every booking button at the booking page, not at the sign in page.

Leak 02 · A service page · Effort: low

The price is four steps away from the page that describes the service

What I found

One of the service pages describes a service in one line, with no price and no button to book it. The page body holds no link and no button at all: the only way to book from it is the item in the top menu. The price does exist. It is inside the booking tool, four steps in: book online, the kind of appointment, the group of services, then the service. I read the page as it renders and as the server sends it, and walked the booking menu, on 10 October.

Why it matters

A visitor who reads about the service and wants to know what it costs finds no figure and nothing to press. Whether showing a price helps or hurts depends on what visitors expect: two field experiments went in opposite directions, and I wrote about both in the hidden prices article on dropoffaudit.me. That question is already settled here, because the business publishes its price. It only does so in a place a reader of this page never reaches.

What fixing it changes

The visitor gets the figure on the page where they are deciding, and a way to act on it.

The fix

Put the price on that service page, next to the service, and add a booking button under it.

Leak 03 · Homepage · Effort: low

The homepage carries no customer's words, and the reviews page is one small link in the footer

What I found

From the first screen to the footer, the homepage shows nothing a customer said: no quote, no star rating, no review card. I walked it in five screenshots and searched its text. The business's testimonials sit on a separate reviews page, and the only way there from the homepage is a link in the footer list, 15 pixels tall, 3,794 pixels down a page that is 3,982 pixels long. The menu at the top of every page has no reviews item. I checked this on 14 October.

Why it matters

To find them, a visitor has to scroll the whole homepage and pick one small link out of the footer list. A visitor who wants to hear from other customers before booking may well go to Google instead, and that is fine. What remains is that the business's own collected praise is not on the homepage. On what the research does and does not say about reviews, see the reviews article on dropoffaudit.me.

What fixing it changes

The award badge on the first screen stops being the only proof on the page.

The fix

Put two or three of the testimonials on the homepage, above the footer, and add Reviews to the top menu.

Leak 04 · Google's AI Mode · Effort: unknown

Asked three times for the service in the business's town, Google's AI Mode never named the business

What I found

On 28 October, between 09:46 and 09:49 UTC, I asked Google's AI Mode for one of the business's services in its town, three times, at least a minute apart. Each answer named five or six businesses. Four of them were named in all three answers. The business was named in none, though its site offers the service and the business is in that town.

Why it matters

A customer who asks that question gets a short list, and this business is not on it. That is all the three answers show. They are one morning's answers, from a browser signed in to a Google account and connecting from Italy. AI Mode answers change and can be personalised, and three answers are not a ranking. I found no study that measures what this does to a business's bookings. What has been measured is that people click through to websites far less when Google answers this way. The study is in the AI Mode article on dropoffaudit.me.

What fixing it changes

I cannot promise that any change to a site gets a business named. Nobody has measured that, and anyone who sells it is guessing.

The fix

Start with what such a system reads first, which is in the business's hands: check that the page title, the description and the business record in the page code each say the service and the town in plain words. Then ask the same question again in a month and compare.

Where to start, in order

In the order I would tackle them: highest return for least effort first.

01 **Point every booking button at the booking page**

Ties back to Leak 01. Effort: low

02 **Put the price on the service page, with a booking button under it**

Ties back to Leak 02. Effort: low

03 **Bring two or three testimonials onto the homepage and add Reviews to the menu**

Ties back to Leak 03. Effort: low

04 **Check what the title, description and business record say, then ask AI Mode again in a month**

Ties back to Leak 04. Effort: unknown

What an audit looks at

The four leaks above are what was worth reporting. These are the things I go through on every site to find them.

- The way to a booking: every button and link that says book, followed to where it ends.
- Prices: whether a visitor can find what a service costs, and how many steps it takes.
- What customers say: testimonials on the site, and the business's Google reviews.
- Links, buttons, phone numbers and email addresses that do not do what they say.
- Leftovers: expired offers, old dates, template text that was never replaced.
- The wording, quoted exactly, where a sentence leaves a visitor unsure what is offered.
- What the site hands to search engines and assistants: the title, the description and the business record.
- Google's AI Mode, asked three times for a service in the business's town.
- Google's public ad library: whether the business is advertising, and what a visitor arriving from an ad meets.

What this audit does not contain

- Any percentage, any revenue estimate, any borrowed industry figure. The impact of each leak is described, not invented.
- The names of the businesses. Where a detail would identify one, it was left out, not changed.
- Anything behind a login or a submitted form. I did not create an account, send a booking or call a phone line.

Questions about anything in this audit? Email me at luca@dropoffaudit.me. I read every response personally.

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